International 2016).[30] The process already started, for example, on July 20, 2016. BRICS approved a $100 million fund for a small-scale energy project in Karelia, Russia (Kulikov 2016). For instance, the NDB extended much-appreciated help to Russia since 2016. The table explains as below (Table 3.6).

Table 3.6 NDB financial help to the Russian Federation from 2016 to 2020 (in US $million)

S.no	Year	Volume (in US $million)
1	2016	100
2	2017	529
3	2018	840
4	2019	1300
5	2020	805

Source NDB annual report, 2020

The question that arises is, what are the main objectives of the Russian foreign policy with the BRICS group?

BRICS and Russia's Foreign Policy Objective

For Russia, BRICS is one means to achieve a strong position in world affairs and a channel for flexible international relations participation. Russia can enhance its influence in world affairs through BRICS. Therefore, BRICS would be one of Russia's strategic tools to maintain global peace and stability to create a democratic world order (Russian Foreign Policy Concept 2008).[31] For Russia, BRICS was a space for asserting its global player status—unlike at G-7/G-8, Russia had always been uncomfortable with partial integration with the West (Cynthia 2010). The Russian Federation Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov in 2012 wrote an article for the Journal titled ‘International Affairs.’ The report stressed that Russia's cooperation with the BRICS was a key long-term foreign policy strategy. Russia understood the step-by-step growth of BRICS and thus paved the way for collaboration into a multilateral strategic partnership and embraced a divergent range of global economics and political affairs issues. Notably, Russia supports positioning BRICS as a nuanced international relations model that overrides the old East–West or North–South binaries. Due to the